

Photograph: CHANTAL ARNTS



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Clockwise from extreme left: Rashmi at Serra with chef Alex Povall; The author with Radha Arora, President of the Rosewood Group; Chef Marius Dufay's masterpieces: Daisy (Left); Plumeria (Right)

sandwiches takeaway counter et al. Not to forget, it's central location, walking distance from Oxford street, Bond street et al.

COMPELLING CULINARY DESTINATION

When food is as impressive in its precision and as gloriously wanton in its luxuriousness, choice is a rite of passage. Rosewood debuts eight exceptional new restaurants and bars. I make time to taste the diverse line-up of restaurants. On top of my list are the two home grown restaurants—the spirit lifting Serra which distils Southern Mediterranean cooking into to the heart of Mayfair. Serra translates to Greenhouse and the sunlight bathed beautiful restaurant aptly focusses on provenance, seasonality, and ingredient-first cooking. I dine in this open-through-the-day Serra, where chef Alex Poval's light and bright dishes refresh.

As for "Jacqueline" (named after Jackie Kennedy Onassis) we're blown away by the one of it's kind tearoom and dessert salon. Here, the passionate & brilliant executive Pastry Chef Marius Dufay creates signature flower collection of pastries, inspired by single blooms, using perfumery techniques. We begin with the amuse bouche of jasmine and caviar and continue nibbling our way through a dazzling array of sweet and savoury masterpieces. The tea sommelier expertly guides us through the UK's largest tea library of over 120 references. My joy is magnified by being in the company of my gorgeous girl friends. All three beauties with brains.

At "Tobi Masa," pristine Japan-flown rare and fresh fish pair with luxurious ingredients (think truffle, caviar and foie gras) within a serene counter setting. His dishes are art, be it composition or temperature; whether he's incorporating white truffle into nigiri or pairing wagyu beef with delicately seasoned rice.

SUITE ENDING

Happily, my sprawling suite is luxurious but most importantly has large windows overlooking the green of Grosvenor square and all the details in it, make it a place that feels lived in.

Thankfully it has no ipads and all those high tech gizmos, but then, sadly, it does not have a Toto toilet either. The butler team connects on whatsapp and turns up like genies, except for a few goof ups. Like the delayed delivery of my bags, soon followed up with a note of apology and a large pure silk eye mask. Ensuring perfection is one of the most respected luxury hoteliers, their GM Michael Bonsor. He is hands-on and a true hospitality superstar. It's serendipity: just by chance I meet Radha Arora, who is visiting from LA and he reiterates: "This is the best hotel with the best address in the no 1 city on the planet." It definitely combines sophistication, a sense of place with hyper-personalised experiences to boot!

Where The Chancery Rosewood, 30 Grosvenor Sq, London W1K 9AN, UK
Cost Junior suite: upwards of £2,200 (₹2,80,783); One bedroom suite: upwards of £5,000 (₹6,38,144); Signature suite: Between £10,000 (₹12,76,287) and £70,000 (₹89,34,009); *Pricing is dynamic, can vary with seasons.